

Now let's look at a tougher case.

My Division. My body is fatally injured, as are the brains of my two brothers. My brain is divided, and each half is successfully transplanted into the body of one of my brothers. Each of the resulting people believes that he is me, seems to remember living my life, has my character, and is in every other way psychologically continuous with me. And he has a body that is very like mine.

Let's call the resulting people *Lefty* and *Righty*. Then we seem to have four options:

- (1) You survive as A.
- (2) You survive as B.
- (3) You survive as both A and B.
- (4) You do not survive.

Parfit argues that none of (1)–(3) can be true. So, he thinks, we are stuck with
option (4): you do not survive.

But this looks bad for the psychological theory; after all, you seem to have the right kinds of connections to both A and B.

Notice that a materialist could also adopt this kind of view. They could say that what is required for your survival is a **non-branching material relation** to some future thing.

But here is an odd consequence of this view. Suppose that you wake up, and are told that you are the result of a hemisphere transplant operation. Next to you on another hospital bed is a body into whom the other hemisphere was transplanted.

You do not yet know whether that body will awake.

You think that you know that you are the person you remember being. But, if that other body survives to become a living person, you will not be the person you remember being.

But how could your identity — who you are — depend on what happens with that other body?

This would explain why you can survive Hemisphere Transplant but not My
Division.

Let's call the resulting people Lefty and Righty. Then we see to have four

options:

(2) You survive as B.

(1) You survive as A.

(4) You do not survive.

(3) You survive as both A and B.

Parfit argues that none of (1)-(3) can be true. So, he thinks, we are stuck with

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But here is another sequence of this view. Suppose that you wake up, and are

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otherbody?

But how could you identify what you are dependent on what happens with that

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D i v i s i o n .

connections.

because the psychological connections to Mars and Venus are branching

Teletransportation Argument. On this kind of view, premises (1) and (2) are false,

This also gives the psychological theorist the resources to resist the

told that you are the result of a hemisphere transplant. Next to you on

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another hospital bed is already in the waiting list

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